

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 723 November 2009 PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Tim Steward enjoys his Labour Weekend at Whanganui Bay

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 2 November 2009

Our New Club President – Peter Cammell



Peter has just become the President of the club and is coming to speak to us.

He will talk some of his recent climbing achievements here and overseas and how this can be accomplished even from his base camp in Auckland. We will also hear where he believes the club is heading in the next few years and in what directions he hopes to lead it. He has some very grand and interesting ideas!

summer rock 10

9 feb - 27 march

introduction to

climbing techniques

leading on bolted routes,

belay and seconding multi-pitch

two weekends in wellington at baring head
and at titahi bay plus two weekends away at
wharepapa south and whanganui bay, taupo

2010 course cost \$550.00



wharepapa



wharepapa



turakirae head



railay beach thailand



mt arapiles australia



darrens fiordland



whanganui bay



mt arapiles australia

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

No previous experience is necessary. The course is also an excellent refresher
check the web for more information about the course

Contact: bh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

mt arapiles australia

New Zealand Mountain Film Festival 2009



The 2009 New Zealand Mountain Film Festival will be held at The Paramount on Tuesday 10 November, starting 6.30 pm. Tickets will be available at the November 2 section nights, and from The Paramount.

South Wye

Come multipitch climbing in the South Wye Valley, high above Lake Whakatipu, Central Otago. The footage conveys the drama and beauty of this special area.

Lost Tower

The story of Kiwi climbers Jo Kippax and Sean Waters as they head to the spectacular North Patagonian Icecap to try and climb the remote 'Lost Tower'.

Kayaking the Nevis

Kayakers have made this film as part of their evidence to support the Kawarau Water Conservation Order, which in turn could stop the proposed hydro scheme on the Nevis River, Central Otago.

Acopan Tepui

German climber Stefan Glowacz and his teammates make a first ascent of Acopan Tepui, an 800 meter rock escarpment high above the South American jungle.

Azazel

French big wall climbers Martial, Blutch, Mimouse and Sam keep the audience entertained as they open a new 1,600 meter aid route on the Towers of Trango in Pakistan.



TRIP REPORTS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Labour Weekend at Whanganui Bay

Our Labour Weekend began early on Friday night, sitting in traffic as we headed north out of Wellington with a car stuffed full of gear. We camped near Rangipo (having been relieved to hear that the murderer who'd escaped the day before had been recaptured...) then finishing the drive to Whanganui Bay having shaken the ice out of our tents the next morning. An absolute cracker of a day greeted us as we bounced down the road towards the bay. Things were looking good.

Saturday saw us heading to Whekenui for a spot of sport and trad climbing. Tim racked up in record time and was steaming up Sayonara before the dust had settled, while ShiChang and I took a more leisurely approach, warming up on ShiChang's Jeans, falling off Small Pocks, and making a gibbering semi-aid ascent of Sayonara.



Steve looking increasingly worried



Tim hanging out above the Bay

Tim and Helen disappeared to tick some classics on Whekenui's stunning corners, arêtes, and cracks while ShiChang and I made tracks for some easier climbs, exploring far and wide before ending the day on James Sterling Direct. Awesome climb with great gear, though I did get a bit wobbly when I saw that the anchors were perched above the final block with no gear in site. Good times.



ShiChang (left) and Steve (right) on James Sterling Direct

Sunday started with a visit to the Up De Do Da Buttress where things looked a bit lichenous and steep, so we left Tim and Helen to it and bailed off to the Plateau to find something easier where they joined us later. A string of 17s quickly fell as we demonstrated our mighty climbing skills, and things were getting a bit carried away when higher grades also proved to be feasible. Hands Solo, complete with gorse bush crux and killer ants at the anchor, was a great way to end the day.

Despite all predictions the weather turned out to be good on Monday morning. We were convinced that we were still able to climb so we knocked back some coffee and it was back to Whekenui for some easy trad as the two teams explored the relatively hidden but fantastic pitches at the right hand end of the crag. As soon as I got a few metres off the ground however I found that the "easy trad" wasn't easy enough for my tired arms- there was much grunting, swearing, and shameful aiding up routes that have probably never been treated so disrespectfully before. We'll call these efforts a recce in preparation for my next visit...

The stalwart team were Helen Alderson, Tim Steward, ShiChang Hou, and Steve Minchin



Helen on Moss Corner, eyeing up the gorse



Tim on James Sterling Direct

Tappy – a classic Labour Weekend trip

As usual, the Labour weekend Friday night ferry had a significant number of trampers and climbers heading across Cook Strait. Our objective was Tappy (Tapuae-o-Uenuku) via the Hodder. Come Saturday morning after a comfortable sleep at the Hodder Bridge car park and a natter to the Pitts of Gladstone Downs Station, it wasn't long before we were down in the river for the first of numerous river crossings. Some of us had opted to dispense with separate boots for climbing, to save some weight. (This time of the year one pair of footwear is all that's needed.) Halfway up valley Chris and Jeroen decided rather than spending all the time in the narrow confines of the Hodder, to expend extra energy to obtain fine weather views by scrambling up and along a section of Tongue Spur (between the Hodder and Shin). Later on this gave them some "excellent" bush bashing through Spaniard and Matagouri as they descended back down to pick up the sidle tack. Anouk and Terry however continued in the Hodder.



Alarm and Mitre from slopes of Tappy

At the huts that evening the weather didn't look too promising, with cloud coming in and light rain. However the next day couldn't have been better; not a cloud in the sky. Snow conditions were excellent – well for us anyhow, since we fortunately left the huts about an hour after the Hutt Valley team, so we only managed to contribute a small amount to the step plugging once we caught up with them, not too far from the summit ridge. We took a standard route onto the west ridge from the basin just to the NW of the summit and had an enjoyable lunch on top along with the other parties. Jeroen and Terry descended down the north ridge and saddle while Anouk and Chris via the ascent route. With much delight and merriment, everyone partook in long high speed bum slides, so we were soon back at the hut for the start of much eating. Coming from the provinces, I was very impressed with the range of nibbles and mains put on by the Wellington based food connoisseurs!

The third day was a relaxed but hot exit back down the Hodder, with one unsuccessful attempt to run down some fresh meat for a lunchtime BBQ.

A highly successful Labour Weekend. The team: Anouk Minnaar (leader), Christian Fremd, Jeroen Sieburg, Terry Crippen (scribe).

AIC Expedition: Objective Angelus

"You're not a trumper anymore, you're a mountaineer!" And so at Don's instruction we set ourselves an objective: Mt Angelus. The forecast is rain but day one surprises us with a clear sky and we set off for the Robert Ridge. After a road walk we hit the Pinchgut track: a hot zig zagging climb out of the bush to warm up the muscles. The best thing about our group is we aren't in any rush. We sit down at regular intervals to appreciate the view, have a snack and a chat, take some photos and soak it up. I think that this was the real 'objective' for all of us: to have a nice time. It's more about the journey than the destination.

Alice imparts some of her geology knowledge, explaining the history of the land below. She and I are invisible rope buddies, Angela and Anouk the same. We make up an international team of American, British, Kiwi and Dutch.

It's a beautiful day with big views. A few gliders pass us overhead, enjoying the thermals as we strip off ours in the heat. The word of the weekend is "gorgeous". This goes down best if exclaimed in an American accent: "Oh my gorgeous!"

The Robert Ridge track consists of a sequence of arcs around basins and across the flanks of small peaks as if you were tracing the outer edge of a holly leaf. For the weary there're a few too many corners to hope are the last but a long day means we get to enjoy a beautiful sunset of pink and gold. We make it to the lakeside hut in the dark and that night the sky is crammed with stars including the bright mass of Jupiter (Alice looked that up afterwards). Gorgeous.



Day two: Still no rain, just more of that inviting blue sky. We all set off for Sunset saddle but Angela and Anouk with day packs only. We use the helpful picture from the climbing guide book to tread a wide sidling arc around and above Hinapouri tarn on perfect cramponing snow. After presuming this would be a waterproofs and gaiters trip it turns out sunscreen and sunnies is more like it.

At the saddle, after a little break of course, Angela and Anouk head back down and out to Speargrass. Alice has been suffering from blisters and kindly offers to wait for me as I continue to the summit. There was definitely an easier route (I spotted it on the way back down) but half an hour of scrabbling around is worth it – from the top there are jaw dropping views all around, barely any wind, so peaceful and... gorgeous.

The upper Hopeless basin is easy travel with grand scenery and a calm atmosphere. There's a pretty lake at the end where we stop for lunch before sidling right for a while then picking a long finger of snow to descend steeply to the valley. There's a lot of avalanche debris so when at last we reach the bush edge we're glad of some easy travel on a flattish path. This, of course, is the place I choose to fall over. It was worth it for the beautiful bruise.

About an hour after sunset when all the sand flies are asleep we pitch our tent on some comfortable grassy flats by the Travers. Heaven is powdered feet, a cosy sleeping bag and a good hot meal finished off with a dessert of Alices's home made brownies and my tastes-a-bit-like-face-cream brandy. Divine.



The next morning I find a fish in my water bottle and boots frozen solid but happily the sun returns, the fish is released, the boots are thawed, more brownies are gobbled and we make a late but contented start and reach the St Arnaud store with 15 minutes to spare – just enough time for an ice lolly (that's an ice block to you locals) and some ginger beer.

It's great to swap stories with other tired and satisfied course mates. Most of us succumb to a post-trip grease fix, gorging ourselves at Picton before washing it down with some contraband wine on the ferry home.

They order up only the best weather and good times for graduates of the AIC!



UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Centennial

Date: 20 – 29 November 2009

Leader: Nina Sawicki

Level: AIC Graduate and 0 - 3 years experience

Trip involves travelling to Franz Josef and then choppering into Centennial Hut for a week of climbing. There are a number of alpine climbing options including The Minarets, De La Beche. For those who like cross-country skiing the Centennial – Pioneer Huts traverse is a must! If you want to try some quality rock the pioneer Range is not far away, and there are multi-pitch classics such as Moonshine Butress (crux 17) nearby as well. Contact Nina Sawicki (csawicki@actrix.co.nz, ph 027 230 5808, or 476 7886)



Centennial Hut on the Franz Josef neve



Annual NZAC Climbing Camp, Matukituki Valley

Date: 2 – 9 January 2010

This years Climbing Camp will be in the Matukituki Valley adjacent to Aspiring Hut, from Saturday 2nd January to Saturday 9th January 2010. It will be hosted by the Otago Section and is a fantastic opportunity for climbers and their families to gather in the mountains for climbing, tramping and generally have fun. There is some fantastic climbing in the area; from the easy peaks of Tyndal and Ansted above Cascade saddle to the many climbs accessible from Colin Todd and French Ridge huts, including Mt Aspiring, Mt French and Mt Avalanche.

See NZAC website for details <http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/377>). Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for carpooling arrangements.



Paynes Ford / Pohara

Date: 22 – 25 January 2010

Leader: ShiChang Hou

Level: Rock grade 15-30

Come spend the long anniversary weekend in 'hippie-ville'. Golden Bay hosts two of the finest limestone crags with long mid-range routes at Pohara and hard classics at Paynes Ford. There is something here for everyone including beaches with white hot sand at Pohara and extensive cool swimming holes adjacent to the Hang Dog campground at Paynes. Relax afterwards with a meal of mussels and Guinness while watching the cricket at the Pohara Pub. Contact ShiChang at sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz





NOTICES



Holdsworth Lodge

From Monday 12th October onwards, Holdsworth Lodge will no longer be left open for casual visitors. This change is being carried out in order to curb ongoing vandalism and to ensure this facility is kept to a high standard for those paying for overnight accommodation.

Bookings for overnight stays are available by contacting the DOC Wellington Visitor Centre on (04) 384 7770 or through the DOC website at <http://booking.doc.govt.nz/>



Wanted – 2010 Rockhop organiser

Hello Wellington climbers!

I have organised the Baring Head Rockhop for the last two years, but next year I am expecting to be chasing a toddler round and I am not going to be able to organise the Rockhop.

What is it?

The 20th Baring Head Rockhop and the Wellington round of the National Boulder Series <http://nbs.org.nz> The NBS is organised centrally by Pat Deavoll in Christchurch who takes care of prizes and will provide t-shirts and promotional posters. Each of the competitions is run by a local organiser.

What does the local organiser do?

Running the Rockhop involves organising people and gear to ensure that all aspects of the competition run smoothly and a good safe time is had by all. Tasks include arranging first aid, assessing weather, route setting, BBQ, taking peoples money and notifying the council and so on. I have had some great helpers over the last two years and there will always be people keen to make it a success.

To be perfectly clear, you do not need to be a brilliant climber to do this, it requires an enthusiastic person with good organisational skills and the ability to delegate! Local climbing geeks are likely to be able to take care of the route setting and there is an expert BBQ handler already signed up! The tasks required to run the comp are really well laid out in the project plan that I can help update and pass on.

Please contact me on callumkennedy@gmail.com if you are interested.

Cheers,
Callum



UIAA Mountain Code

The September 2009 UIAA newsletter includes an article on the new UIAA Mountain Code which is being undertaken by a group of climbers including our own John Nankervis. This code puts into ink mountaineering's longstanding values of good sportsmanship, respect for cultures and care for the environment. It also addresses some of the biggest debates in mountaineering today, such as the use of bottled oxygen on 8,000-meter-peak attempts. The intent, say mountaineers involved in the process, is to create a document that reflects the sport's high ideals and evolves with changing times.

The draft includes 12 maxims on a range of topics relating to mountaineering. One key theme is the interaction with the landscape and the people who inhabit it. The document calls for climbers to be knowledgeable and conscientious of the cultural norms of host nations. The same holds true for environmental issues. It stipulates that mountaineers should practice their activities in "an environmentally sensitive way and be proactive in preserving nature". "We strive to leave no trace," the draft states.

Mutual respect and team commitment are core climbing ideals, the paper adds. This ranges from how clients should treat their guides to how alpinists should approach a first ascent.

www.theuiaa.org/newsletter/September09.html



Gear donations

The Wellington section has been fortunate to receive two gifts of climbing equipment for instructional purposes. The first was a 9mm rope from the estate of Andrew Lynch. The second was from the estate of Warren Herrick, and included a 9mm rope, a range of nuts, and a snow stake.

The section is very grateful for this gear, and looks forward to putting it to use in the coming year.



Cameron Glacier – snow stakes

Alice Doughty from Victoria University of Wellington will be studying mass balance and flow rates of Cameron Glacier over the next few years. She is hoping to quantify past climate within this valley using maps of the moraine system, moraine ages, and computer models. To make the model more realistic, measurements of the modern glacier must be collected. The stakes will be drilled into the glacier November 2009 and left over summer and then removed February 2010. Please respect the scientific research and do not move or tamper with the equipment (ten white, 7-m long snow stakes). Thank You!

Please feel free to contact Alice about her research:

Email: alice.doughty@gmail.com

Antarctic Research Centre, Victoria University of Wellington, Wellington 6012



Photographic Competition



On November 23rd 1909, Major Bernard Head, Jack Clarke and Alec Graham made the first ascent of Mt Aspiring/ Tititea. To celebrate the centenary of this ascent, the New Zealand Alpine Club is holding a Photographic Competition to find the best photo of the mountain.

Entry specifics:

- The competition is open to everyone, not just NZAC members, and is limited to one photo per person.
- The photo can be a landscape, an aerial shot, or can include an outdoor pursuit involving Mt Aspiring / Tititea, like climbing, skiing or parapenting.
- **Digital images only will be accepted.** These must be in jpeg format between 500 KB and 2 MB and be submitted on a CD. Images must not be digitally manipulated in any way apart from cropping, resizing, exposure or tonal adjustments. CD's must have the name of the photographer on them.
- On entering, competitors automatically agree their images can be displayed to the public in Wanaka and used by the competition sponsors **Mainly Tramping**, the **Department of Conservation** and the **NZAC** for promotional activities.
- Entries must be accompanied by the entrants name, email address and phone number.
- Entries will be judged by a panel of two or more judges and the winner announced at the Mt Aspiring Centenary Celebration at the Lake Wanaka Centre, Wanaka, on November 28th.

First prize: Mainly Tramping voucher for \$500 worth of climbing equipment.

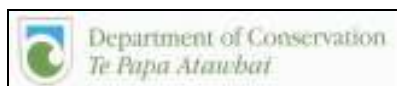
Second prize: Department of Conservation (Wanaka) book voucher worth \$50.

Third prize: NZAC new updated 'Mt Aspiring Region: Guide for Mountaineers', worth \$25.

Entries are now open, and close Tuesday, 17th November.

Please send your entries to: **Photographic Competition, NZAC Home of Mountaineering, Unit 6/6 Raycroft St, P.O.Box 786, Opawa, Christchurch.**

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Carry a load for a Sherpa!

Outdoors people are being invited to buy a Himalayan Trust eco-bag to support the Sherpa people of Nepal.

November's Himalayan Trust fundraiser aims to help the Trust continue its work with schools, health services, building and reforestation projects in the Sherpa region of Nepal.

Established in 1960, Lady June Hillary now leads the work of the Himalayan Trust, maintaining the long relationship between New Zealanders and the Sherpa people. Current support to 63 schools includes provision of textbooks and stationery, teacher training and scholarships. Health care work has involved tuberculosis control, cataract operations, and immunisation of TB, measles, tetanus and polio while the reforestation programme has seen more than 100,000 local origin trees planted.

Lady Hillary believes the eco-bag fundraiser builds on the proud history shared by New Zealanders and the Sherpa people. "We have this great history of adventure and having a go, and the idea of lending a hand through carrying a load for a Sherpa offers a nice symmetry for New Zealanders wanting to get behind the Trusts work".

Fundraiser eco-bags will be available from Macpac stores and selected Bivouac outlets (Auckland, Wellington and Christchurch) in the latter part of November. Bags are made of jute fibre and are robust enough to be used and reused for outdoor gear, groceries, picnics, or storing items around the house or in the car. Bags will also make great gifts for friends and family. The bags are \$20 and provide a practical, environmentally friendly, and attractive way to support the work of the Trust.

Anyone wanting to find out more about the work of the Trust can view the website www.himalayantrust.co.nz. Those wishing to make further donations to the Himalayan Trust can do so at any branch of BNZ or post a donation to Lady Hillary, Chairman Himalayan Trust, PO Box 28742, Remuera, Auckland.

Himalayan Trust History

- The Himalayan Trust was established in 1960 by Sir Edmund Hillary.
- Projects commonly involve cooperative efforts of New Zealand and Sherpa volunteers.
- The first project involved building the Khumjung school, 27 schools have subsequently been established and support is now provided to 63 schools.
- Planning and implementation of Trust work is always carried out jointly by the Trust and local community on a partnership basis.
- The Trust believes that success can be achieved only through continuity of work.



2010 Alpine Climbing Camp

The Otago section will be hosting this year's 2010 Alpine Climbing Camp in the Matukituki Valley and we look forward to welcoming you there. We anticipate that it will be a very popular camp given its great location and huge range of climbing options. There is some fantastic climbing in the area there are the easy peaks of Plunket Dome, Islington Dome, Liverpool, Tyndal and Ansted which are accessible from Cascade Saddle. There are many climbs accessible from Colin Todd and French Ridge huts of varying levels of difficulty including Mt Aspiring, Mt French and Mt Avalanche.

Tramping in the area includes Cascade Saddle, Rees Saddle and trips to the French Ridge and Liverpool Huts. If you are on your own and we will facilitate finding other people with similar abilities and aspirations for you to climb with.

We really want to encourage members of varying abilities to come and enjoy the fantastic setting, you don't need to be an expert or 'hard as nails' to have a great time at the Climbing Camp. Social climbing is a very worthwhile activity too! The camp will be at the campsite next to Aspiring Hut – the venue could not be better.

We would like to encourage early registration as we anticipate that interest will be high and we shall have to limit numbers at just over 100 due to site factors, so please visit <http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/377> to find the registration form.



Wanted – 2008 NZAC Alpine Journals

Dave Bamford (Wellington) would like to purchase a couple of 2008 NZAC Journals for some family friends of Sir Ed's family. If you are able to assist, please contact him at dave@trcnz.com or phone 04 568 6088.



Telemark boots and bindings

Ossie's in Ohakune are having a clearance of their old stuff:

- Veloce Garmont boots, sizes from 25.5 – 31, all brand new in box, \$400/pair
- Telesaurus boots, size 25.5, 9 pairs, \$350/pair
- Ener – G, size 26.5, 1 pair, \$500
- Squadra G Fit, size 30.5, 1 pair
- Also Riva 1 and Riva 2 bindings.

Contact Rebekah Burn: rebekah_burn@hotmail.com



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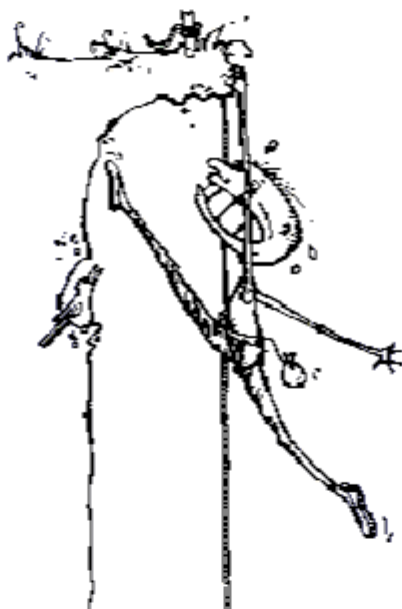
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Acting Treasurer	Richard Davies	Treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Scott Taylor	ST	
Trips	Kevin Patterson	Trips or KP	04 934 0975 (h) 027 687 9573
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Scott Taylor	ST	
	ShiChang Hou	SH	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Max Gough	MG	
	Hinrich Schaefer		
	Rebecca Thomson		
Other Roles:			
Gear	Blair Hiscoke	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Kevin Patterson	PLB or KP	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	06 3777 117 (h) 027 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	03 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

